

Chicago Tribune



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THURSDAY, JANUARY 22, 2026

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



President Donald Trump is visible on a video monitor as he addresses the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, on Wednesday. Trump told European leaders during the speech that doesn't "have to" use force to seize Greenland. **DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

On Greenland, Trump's messages weave in, out

President reverses EU tariff threat, shows ambivalence on using force

By Josh Boak, Will Weissert and Aamer Madhani

Associated Press

DAVOS, Switzerland — President Donald Trump announced Wednesday that he was scrapping his planned tariffs on eight European nations in an effort to force U.S. control over Greenland, pulling a dramatic reversal shortly after insisting he wanted to get the island “including right, title and ownership.”

In a post on his social media site, Trump said he had agreed with the head of NATO on a “framework of a future deal” on Arctic security.

He said “additional discussions” on Greenland were being held concerning the Golden Dome missile defense program, a multilayered, \$175 billion system that for the first time will put U.S. weapons in space.

The president has threatened tariffs before only to back away. In April, after first saying he would slap massive import levies on nations from around the world, which

Trump flexes muscle of the Oval Office

During the first year of his second term, President Donald Trump used the Oval Office in a way his predecessors haven't, as a veritable reality show with a revolving cast of world leaders. More than 40 international leaders made the trek to Washington to meet with the American president last year, many with the cameras rolling. There were ambushes, threats, obsequious displays and realignments of long-standing U.S. foreign policy. **Nation & World in Business, Page 5**

prompted a sharp negative market reaction, Trump eased off.

But his change of heart this time came only after he used his speech at the World Economic Forum in the Swiss Alps to focus on Greenland and to threaten to upend NATO, an alliance that has been among the globe's most unshakable since the early days of the Cold War.

In his address, Trump said he was asking for territory that was “cold and poorly located” and that the U.S. had effectively saved Europe during World War II while declaring of NATO: “It's a very small ask compared to what we have given them for many, many decades.”

“We probably won't get anything unless I decide to use excessive strength and force, where we would be frankly unstoppable. But I won't do that, OK?” Trump said, later adding, “I don't have to” and “I don't want to use force.”

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BOVINO BOUNTY TRIAL

Suspect in plot doesn't testify

In video, Little Village man tells feds alleged messages were social media chatter

By Jason Meisner

Chicago Tribune

Shortly after his arrest in early October, Little Village construction worker Juan Espinoza Martínez was led by three federal agents into a windowless interview room, still dressed in a green work T-shirt and carrying a small bottle of water.

“You're probably a little confused about what's going on today, so I'm gonna try to explain it all to you,” Homeland Security Investigations Special Agent Christopher Perugini told Espinoza Martínez at the outset of the Oct. 6 videotaped interview, which was played for a federal jury Wednesday. “Feel free to ask me any questions you want.”

Then, the agents laid it on the 37-year-old father of three why he was there.

“Murder for hire?” Espinoza Martínez responded, holding up his hands questioningly.

“Correct, so that's what the charge you're charged with,” Perugini said. “I'll explain it to you as we're going.”

The agents then confronted Espinoza Martínez with text messages he'd sent an acquaintance that included a photo of Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino, who was then the face of Operation

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■ An appeals court on Wednesday suspended a decision that restricts immigration officers' aggressive tactics in Minnesota. **Nation & World**

ELECTION 2026 7TH CONGRESSIONAL DISTRICT

Ad reveals spending loophole

Conyears-Ervin taps state campaign cash for message aimed at Washington bid

By Rick Pearson

Chicago Tribune

In a new TV ad, Democrat Melissa Conyears-Ervin declares to viewers she's not “afraid to stand up to Donald Trump” and will “fight” for affordable health care and groceries.

Various graphics beneath her name flash that she will “Fight Trump and MAGA” and “Protect Medicare, Medicaid and SNAP from Trump's Cuts,” referring to the Republican president's “Make America Great Again” followers and the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, issues befitting a U.S. House candidate seeking the Democratic nomination in a crowded race for the 7th Congressional District.

At the end of her ad, another graphic displays, “Melissa Conyears-Ervin, Democrat, 7th Congressional District.” But look a little closer, and in smaller letters are the words “State Central Committee.” The ad also says: “Paid for by Melissa for Chicago.”

The subtleties might not seem significant to the average viewer, but they signal

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Chicagoland braces for another Arctic blast

Windchill may hit minus 35, with worst Friday morning

By Christiana Freitag

Chicago Tribune

Polar vortexes are a year-round phenomenon. But Chicago-area residents only notice them when they collapse, experts say.

That's what's happening starting Thursday when dangerously frigid air from Siberia and the North Pole is forecast to plunge the Great Lakes region into subzero territory for multiple days.

“A piece of (the polar vortex) will break off and meander southward into our area,” said Gino Izzi, a senior meteorologist with the National Weather Service.

The National Weather Service has issued an extreme cold watch from 4 a.m. Thursday until noon Friday for Chicago as well as central, north central and northeast Illinois, said NWS Chicago meteorologist Zachary Yack.

The most severe stretch will occur Thursday night into Friday morning, when windchills in Chicago and the northwest suburbs are expected to reach up to minus 35, although subzero temperatures are also forecast through Sunday, said Yack.

But this is nowhere near Jan. 20, 1985, when Chicago experienced its coldest day on record: minus 27 degrees and a windchill of minus 57.

A polar vortex is a constant cold,

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Kurt Bushing, an employee of the Fox Lake Public Works Department, uses a snowblower to clear snow near the community ice rink at Lakefront Park on Tuesday in Fox Lake. Subzero temperatures are expected through Sunday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

UPCOMING FORECAST

Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
High 24 Low -12	High -2 Low -8	High 10 Low 7	High 17 Low -3

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

STAYING SAFE: Officials in Chicago and Cook County are warning residents about the dangers of being outdoors during this severe cold stretch, urging people to wear multiple layers of clothing and take frequent breaks to warm up.

Report: City overpaid OT

The city of Chicago doled out \$26.5 million in overtime in recent years to likely over 1,000 government employees who should not have gotten it, according to a report released Wednesday by the inspector general. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Sox send Robert to Mets

Luis Robert Jr.'s name had been mentioned constantly in trade speculation over the last couple of years. The talk became reality late Tuesday when the Sox dealt the center fielder to the Mets for two players, including a pitching prospect. **Chicago Sports**

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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